antisemitism," the EU was about to lose its credibility.[12] The EU was nonetheless willing to take that risk.

Within two months of the disappearance of that definition, one that explicitly delineated anti-Zionism's antisemitic manifestations, the European Commission (the EU's executive body) banned funding for Israeli institutions in those territories it identified as occupied.[13] Days later, as if to play an even hand, the EU's Council (comprised of 28 Member States) added Hezbollah's "military wing" to a list of terrorist organizations precluded from financial assistance.[14]

Such pivots could defy explanation were they not reminiscent of a pattern known as "bait-and-switch." Ashton's catchall condemnation of contemporary racism—one devoid of acknowledging antisemitism—was a poor substitute for commemorating the Holocaust. Likewise, removing the definition of antisemitism in advance of issuing a report on the subject is similar to sanctioning Israel before censuring Hezbollah's "military wing." Each seemingly even-handed pair of actions is, in fact, deeply imbalanced: one undercuts the rights of Jews to live in peace (whether as EU nationals or as a nation) while the other offers rhetorical redress to the adversaries of antisemitism.

To those for whom the deceits associated with bait-and-switch can seem minor, the Nobel Prize-winning economist George Akerlof explains: those "who wish to pawn bad wares as good wares" tend to drive out legitimate business. Thus, "The cost of dishonesty. . .lies not only in the amount by which the purchaser is cheated; the cost also must include the loss incurred from driving legitimate business out of existence."[15] Akerlof's insights extend to the EU's legislative and diplomatic arenas as well. There, Europe's political actors marketed questionable policies to its Jewish nationals, their organizations, and the Jewish state. Exploring why and how Jews may have been played might afford some remedy. To this end, we will examine in greater detail those EU efforts we just touched on.

As we consider the EU's unofficial "working definition of antisemitism," its formal sanctions against Israeli institutions, and its ostensible censure of Hezbollah, we start with the politics surrounding the definition's informal adoption and dissemination and consider how, far from offering Jews potential redress, it provided the illusion of relief and delivered little.

Addressing antisemitism within the EU first requires that we reveal a deception surrounding it—namely that this polity has long been (and continues to remain) active in the fight against anti-Jewish hatred. However, like racism in general, Europe's initial architects regarded antisemitism as an internal national problem in which the European Community had little

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